

Maria Silva

38, Marlborough Road, Maidenhead, Berkshire · +447935308070 · mariafgsilva10@gmail.com ·
linkedin.com/in/mariafgsilva10

LLB and LLM graduate with practical experience supporting residential and commercial property matters, complex disputes and client-facing legal work. At BCLP's Real Estate Disputes team, managed multi-file caseloads, maintained matter records on iManage, prepared hearing bundles and assisted with court filings across landlord and tenant, leasehold and rights of light matters. At Citizens Advice, handles housing and property queries alongside broader casework, drafting correspondence, preparing document schedules and maintaining confidential files to deadline. Strong client communication skills, with experience translating procedural requirements into clear guidance for individuals under pressure.

EDUCATION

Comparative and International Dispute Resolution LLM — Merit **Sept 2024 – Oct 2025**

Queen Mary University of London

- International arbitration, dispute resolution, procedural issues, legal research and evidence analysis
- Transnational Law and Governance Applied module (data privacy and democracy) — 75%
- Dissertation: data protection and the development of GDPR across jurisdictions

Law LLB — 2:1

Sept 2020 – June 2024

University College London

- Alternative Dispute Resolution, Advanced Contract Law, Commercial Law, Company Law

International Foundation Programme of Law and International Relations

Sept 2019 – June 2020

King's College London

- Awarded the Leaders of Tomorrow prize (top 20 of 200-student cohort; partial funding toward undergraduate degree)

EXPERIENCE

Bryan Cave Leighton Paisner LLP (BCLP) · London

Feb 2024 – Aug 2024

Legal Placement Student — Real Estate Disputes

- Supported several live residential and commercial property matters concurrently, including landlord and tenant disputes, leasehold issues and rights of light cases
- Prepared and organised electronic hearing bundles, skeleton argument materials and court documents to strict deadlines
- Maintained matter records and document management on iManage across a high-volume caseload with competing deadlines
- Assisted with court filings, hearing logistics, matter opening and closure, and cost comparisons
- Reviewed title documents, lease agreements and property-related evidence; conducted legal and factual research on easements and leasehold law
- Prepared client attendance notes and maintained confidential matter records throughout

Bryan Cave Leighton Paisner LLP (BCLP) · London

Aug 2023 – Feb 2024

Legal Placement Student — International Arbitration

- Supported a complex investment arbitration: reviewed and organised evidence for procedural submissions and the Claimant's memorial
- Drafted procedural orders and procedural histories; amended sections of the Claimant's memorial under supervision
- Became the sole junior supporting the team ahead of a significant filing deadline, coordinating documents and tracking outstanding actions to ensure on-time submission
- Maintained structured electronic case files and monitored procedural deadlines throughout the matter
- Liaised with the client on required documents; coordinated translations with an external translator

- Received feedback from a partner and associate that performance was comparable to a newly qualified solicitor

Citizens Advice East Berkshire · Maidenhead

July 2026 – Present

Legal Adviser

- Handles housing and property queries alongside welfare benefits, employment, family, debt and consumer matters
- Takes detailed client instructions, establishes chronologies and identifies relevant legal and evidential issues at first interview
- Manages matters from instruction through to completion: drafts correspondence, prepares applications and document schedules, maintains confidential case records and meets deadlines
- Translates complex procedural requirements into clear, practical guidance for clients, including those under financial or personal pressure
- Researches complex points of law and procedure, including statutory eligibility criteria and regulatory requirements

Q-Legal · Remote

Oct 2024 – Jan 2025

Legal Adviser

- Managed a data privacy matter from client instruction through to formal written advice, under qualified solicitor supervision
- Researched UK GDPR and Data Protection Act 2018 obligations for a data-driven start-up; identified compliance risks and recommended practical mitigations
- Translated complex statutory requirements into clear, commercially focused written advice; met client and supervisor deadline throughout

Adobe · London

June 2022 – Aug 2022

Legal Intern

- Reviewed and amended software licensing agreements; identified contractual risks and assessed alignment with internal legal requirements
- Reviewed confidentiality and data processing provisions; researched UK GDPR, EU GDPR and cross-border data transfer requirements
- Liaised with sales, legal and international business teams to resolve contractual queries and reconcile commercial objectives with legal risk
- Prepared and delivered an internal presentation on breach of contract risks and mitigation measures

SKILLS

Languages: Portuguese (native), English (fluent), Spanish (basic)

Technical skills: iManage document management; Microsoft Word, Excel and PowerPoint; legal research databases; electronic court filing portals; electronic bundling; case management and time-recording systems; document review

Case and evidence management: Hearing bundle preparation, matter file organisation, deadline tracking, procedural document drafting, client correspondence, confidential record-keeping across multi-file caseloads